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Digital document organizer service

Abstract

A method performed by a computer system for providing a digital document organizer service is disclosed. The method includes generating a digital document organizer for a user of an online software platform, adding at least a digital document to the digital document organizer, wherein the digital document represents a certification issued by a certifying authority, generating metadata associated with the digital document based on analyzing the digital document, storing metadata associated with the digital document, receiving, over a network, a request by the user to view the digital document, retrieving the digital document from a database in response to receiving a request to view the digital document, and transmitting the digital document and the metadata associated with the digital document to a device operated by the user as a response to the request to view the document.

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Background/Summary**BACKGROUND**

(1) Businesses are often required to carry various kinds of documentation that show proof of compliance or qualification related to their business, and to present the documentation when requested. For example, a business may be required to carry a proof of tax compliance, a proof of insurance, a business license, a health department approval, an alcohol license, a wholesale license, etc. As a further example, a professional service provider (e.g., electrician, general contractor, and/or other licensed professional) may be required to carry documentation showing that the service provider is licensed to perform certain services or other proof of qualification. It can be burdensome and inconvenient for business owners (or agents of the business) to carry around such documentation and to make the documentation available upon request, particularly if the business involves traveling to various sites (e.g., plumbing services and electrician services) and/or involves on-site public interaction (e.g., retail stores and restaurants). Sometimes it is difficult for a business to know what type of documentation it needs to carry to be compliant with various rule and regulations. Certifications issued by certifying authorities often have to be renewed on a recurring basis. Not renewing a certification in a timely manner may result in levying of fines and/or loss of operations. Having to carry documentation, present the documentation upon request, and keep track of renewal dates can be burdensome and cause anxiety for business owners.

(2) All subject matter discussed in this Background section of this document is not necessarily prior art, and may not be presumed to be prior art simply because it is presented in this Background section. Plus, any reference to any prior art in this description is not, and should not be taken as, an acknowledgement or any form of suggestion that such prior art forms parts of the common general knowledge in any art in any country. Along these lines, any recognition of problems in the prior art discussed in this Background section or associated with such subject matter should not be treated as prior art, unless expressly stated to be prior art. Rather, the discussion of any subject matter in this Background section should be treated as part of the approach taken towards the particular problem by the inventors. This approach in and of itself may also be inventive.

SUMMARY

(3) The present description gives instances of computer systems, storage media that may store programs, and methods.

(4) In embodiments, an online software platform (OSP) computer system is configured to provide a digital document organizer service. The OSP computer system may generate a digital document organizer for a user of the OSP, add at least a digital document to the digital document organizer,

wherein the digital document represents a certification issued by a certifying authority, generate metadata associated with the digital document based on analyzing the digital document, store the metadata associated with the digital document, receive, over a network, a request by the user to view the digital document, retrieve the digital document from a database in response to receiving the request to view the digital document, and transmit, over the network, the digital document and the metadata associated with the digital document to a device operated by the user as a response to the request to view the document. The digital document may be provided by the user (e.g., in the request itself), pulled/imported from a certifying authority, or pushed by the certifying authority to the OSP computer system via an application programming interface (API) exposed by the OSP towards the certifying authority.

(5) An advantage of the digital document organizer service can be that it allows users of the OSP to store, organize, and manage digital documents in a centralized manner. The digital document organizer service may allow users to use their computing devices to easily and quickly access their digital documents on demand from anywhere they have network access. This avoids the need for users to carry around physical documentation papers.

(6) In an embodiment, the OSP computer system determines that a notification associated with the digital document is to be generated based on the metadata associated with the digital document, generates the notification associated with the digital document in response to the determination that the notification associated with the digital document is to be generated, and transmits, over the network, the notification associated with the digital document such that the user can view the notification. In an embodiment, the metadata associated with the digital document includes an expiration date associated with the digital document, wherein the determination that the notification associated with the digital document is to be generated is based on a determination that the expiration date is less than a threshold number of days away from a current date.

(7) An advantage of the digital document organizer service may be that it notifies users when certifications are about to expire, which helps ensure that the users can operate their business without penalties and without disruption of services.

(8) In an embodiment, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to share one or more documents in the digital document organizer with a third party and shares the one or more documents with the third party in response to receiving the request to share the one or more documents. In an embodiment, the one or more documents are shared with the third party by generating a link that is usable by the third party to access the one or more documents and transmitting, over the network, the link to the third party such that the third party can use the link to access the one or more digital documents. In an embodiment, the link is a uniform resource locator (URL) that includes a query string, wherein the query string includes an indication of the one or more digital documents being shared, an indication of access rights being granted, an indication of an access expiration date, and a digital signature that was generated based on parts of the query string and signed by a private key.

(9) An advantage of the digital document organizer service may be that it allows user to easily share digital documents with third parties in a secure manner.

(10) In an embodiment, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to generate a compliance badge, generates the compliance badge in response to a determination that the digital document organizer includes a set of documents that fulfill a set of requirements associated with the compliance badge, and transmits, over the network, the compliance badge such that the compliance badge can be published to an external platform.

(11) Having a compliance badge issued by the OSP may help increase customer confidence in the business.

(12) As such, it will be appreciated that results of embodiments are larger than the sum of their individual parts, and have utility.

(13) These and other features and advantages of the claimed invention will become more readily

apparent in view of the embodiments described and illustrated in this specification, namely in this written specification and the associated drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The invention may best be understood by referring to the following description and accompanying drawings that are used to illustrate embodiments of the invention. In the drawings:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a diagram showing sample aspects of embodiments.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a diagram showing operations for generating a digital document organizer, according to embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a diagram showing operations for adding a digital document to a digital document organizer, according to embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 4A is a diagram showing operations for generating metadata associated with a digital document, according to embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 4B is a diagram showing operations for generating a notification associated with a digital document, according to embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 4C is a diagram showing operations for generating and storing a hash value associated with a digital document, according to embodiments.
- (8) FIG. 5 is a diagram showing operations for retrieving a digital document, according to embodiments.
- (9) FIG. 6A is a diagram showing operations for sharing a digital document with a third party, according to embodiments.
- (10) FIG. 6B is a diagram showing operations for sharing a digital document with a third party with specified access rights until a specified access expiration date/time, according to embodiments.
- (11) FIG. 7 is a diagram showing operations for allowing a certifying authority to add, update, and/or delete digital documents, according to embodiments.
- (12) FIG. 8 is a diagram showing operations for generating a compliance badge, according to embodiments.
- (13) FIG. 9A and FIG. 9B are flowcharts describing methods, according to embodiments.
- (14) FIG. 10 shows details for example computer systems, according to embodiments.
- (15) FIG. 11 is diagram for an operational example and use case where the digital document organizer is a digital wallet for storing, organizing, and managing digital documents representing business documents.
- (16) FIG. 12A, FIG. 12B, and FIG. 12C are flowcharts describing methods for a digital wallet use case, according to embodiments.
- (17) FIG. 13A is a diagram showing a GUI for uploading a digital document to a digital wallet service, according to embodiments.
- (18) FIG. 13B is a diagram showing a GUI for uploading a digital document to a digital wallet service after the user has provided a digital document to be uploaded, according to embodiments.
- (19) FIG. 14 is a diagram showing a GUI for sharing a digital document, according to embodiments.
- (20) FIG. 15 is a diagram showing another GUI for sharing a digital document, according to embodiments.
- (21) FIG. 16A is a diagram showing an email informing a third party that a user of the OSP has shared digital credentials with the third party, according to embodiments.
- (22) FIG. 16B is a diagram showing a GUI for viewing digital documents shared by a user of the OSP, according to embodiments.
- (23) FIG. 17A is a diagram showing a GUI for notifying a user that a credential is about to expire,

according to embodiments.

(24) FIG. 17B is a diagram showing an email for notifying a user of the OSP that a credential is about to expire, according to embodiments.

(25) FIG. 18 is a diagram showing a GUI for publishing a compliance badge, according to embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(26) As has been mentioned, the present description is about computer systems, storage media that may store programs, and methods. Embodiments are now described in more detail.

(27) FIG. 1 is a diagram showing sample aspects of embodiments.

(28) A sample online software platform (OSP) computer system **195** according to embodiments is shown. The OSP computer system **195** may optionally be implemented as part of an online software platform (OSP) **198**. As such, the OSP computer system **195** can be located in “the cloud.”

(29) The OSP computer system **195** has one or more processors **194** and a memory **130**. The memory **130** stores programs **131** and data **138**. As shown in the diagram, the programs **131** include various components that can be used for providing a digital document organizer service to users of the OSP **198** such as a digital document organizer generator **150**, a digital document adder **152**, a digital document analyzer **154**, a notification generator **156**, a digital document retriever **158**, a digital document sharer **160**, a digital document organizer application programming interface (API) **162**, and a compliance badge generator **164**. The data **138** may include digital document organizers **170** for different users of the OSP **198**. For example, the diagram shows the data **138** including digital document organizers **170A** (e.g., for user A), **170B** (e.g., for user B), and **170X** (e.g., for user X). Each digital document organizer **170** may include one or more digital documents **172** and each digital document **172** may have metadata **174** associated with it. For example, as shown in the diagram, digital document organizer **170A** includes digital document **172A** and its associated metadata **174A**, digital document **172B** and its associated metadata **174B**, and digital document **172N** and its associated metadata **174N**. It should be noted that the diagram shows a logical depiction of the data **138** for sake of illustration and is not meant to show how the data **138** is actually stored in the memory **130**. Those skilled in the art will understand that there are various possible ways that the data **138** may be stored, structured, and organized in the memory **130** (e.g., the digital documents **172** and the metadata **174** may be stored in separate databases and/or database tables). In an embodiment, digital document organizers **170** (including the digital documents **172** and/or metadata therein) are stored in encrypted form.

(30) The one or more processors **194** and the memory **130** of the OSP computer system **195** may implement a service engine **183** for providing the digital document organizer service. Additional implementation details for the OSP computer system **195** are given later in this document.

(31) The OSP **198** can be configured to perform one or more predefined services, for example via operations of the service engine **183**. Such services can be searches, determinations, computations, verifications, notifications, the transmission of specialized information, including data that effectuates payments, the generation and transmission of documents, the online accessing other systems to effect registrations, and so on, including what is described in this document. Such services can be provided as a Software as a Service (SaaS).

(32) A user **192** may be standalone. The user **192** may use a computer system **190** that has a screen **191**, on which User Interfaces (UIs) may be shown. Additional sample implementation details for the computer system **190** are given later in this document. In embodiments, the user **192** and the computer system **190** are considered part of an entity **193**. In such instances, the user **192** can be an agent of the entity **193**, and even within a physical site of the entity **193**, although that is not necessary. In embodiments, the computer system **190** or other device of the user **192** are client devices for the OSP computer system **195**. The user **192** or the entity **193** can be clients/customers of the OSP **198**. For instance, the user **192** may log into the OSP computer system **195** by using credentials, such as a user name, a password, a token, and so on to access service provided by the

OSP 198.

(33) The computer system **190** may access the OSP computer system **195** via a communications network **188**, such as the internet. In particular, the entities and associated systems of FIG. **1** may communicate via physical and logical channels of the communication network **188**. For example, information may be communicated as data using the Internet Protocol (IP) suite over a packet-switched network such as the internet or other packet-switched network, which may be included as part of the communication network **188**. The communication network **188** may include many different types of computer networks and communication media including those utilized by various different physical and logical channels of communication, now known or later developed. Non-limiting media and communication channel examples include one or more, or any operable combination of: fiber optic systems, satellite systems, cable systems, microwave systems, asynchronous transfer mode (“ATM”) systems, frame relay systems, digital subscriber line (“DSL”) systems, radio frequency (“RF”) systems, telephone systems, cellular systems, other wireless systems, and the internet. In various embodiments the communication network **188** can be or include any type of network, such as a local area network (LAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), a wide area network (WAN), or the internet. Accordingly, from certain perspectives, the OSP **198** is in the cloud, and can be drawn within the communication network **188**.

(34) The computer system **190** and the OSP computer system **195** may exchange requests and responses with each other. Such can be implemented with a number of architectures.

(35) In one such architecture, a device remote to the service engine **183**, such as the computer system **190**, may have a certain application (not shown) and a connector (not shown) that is a plugin that sits on top of that certain application. The connector may be able to fetch from the remote device the details required for the service desired from the OSP **198**, form an object or payload **134**, and then send or push a request **184** that carries the payload **134** to the service engine **183** via a service call. The service engine **183** may receive the request **184** with the payload **134**. The service engine **183** may then perform operations based on the payload **134**, form a payload **137** that is an aspect of the performed operations, and then push, send, or otherwise cause to be transmitted a response **187** that carries the payload **137** to the connector. The connector reads the response **187** and forwards the payload **137** to the certain application.

(36) In an alternative such architecture, a device remote to the service engine **183**, such as the computer system **190**, may have a particular application (not shown). In addition, the OSP computer system **195** implements a REST (Representational State Transfer) API (Application Programming Interface) (not shown). REST or RESTful API design is designed to take advantage of existing protocols. While REST can be used over nearly any protocol, it usually takes advantage of HTTP (Hyper Text Transfer Protocol) when used for Web APIs. This alternative architecture enables the entity **193** to directly consume a REST API from their particular application, without using a connector. The particular application of the remote device may be able to fetch internally from the remote device the details required for the service desired from the OSP **198**, and thus send or push the request **184** to the REST API. In turn, the REST API talks in the background to the service engine **183**. Again, the service engine **183** performs operations, and sends an aspect of the performed operations back to the REST API. In turn, the REST API sends the response **187** that has the payload **137** to the particular application.

(37) Moreover, in some embodiments, data from the computer system **190** and/or from the OSP computer system **195** may be stored in an Online Processing Facility (OPF) **189** that can run software applications, perform operations, and so on. In such embodiments, requests and responses may be exchanged with the OPF **189**. In such embodiments, the computer system **190** and any devices of the OPF **189** can be considered to be remote devices, at least from the perspective of the OSP computer system **195**.

(38) In an embodiment, as mentioned above, the OSP computer system **195** may implement a service engine **183** for providing a digital document organizer service to users of the OSP **198**. The

OSP computer system **195** may provide the digital document organizer service based on executing programs **131** stored in the memory **130**. These programs **131** may include various components such as the digital document organizer generator **150**, the digital document adder **152**, the digital document analyzer **154**, the notification generator **156**, the digital document retriever **158**, the digital document sharer **160**, the digital document organizer API **162**, and/or the compliance badge generator **164**.

(39) As will be described in additional detail herein, the digital document organizer generator **150** may be used to generate a new digital document organizer **170** for a user of the OSP **198** (e.g., for user **192**). The digital document adder **152** may be used to add a digital document to an existing digital document organizer **170**. The digital document analyzer **154** may be used to analyze a digital document **172** to generate metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172**. The notification generator **156** may be used to generate a notification associated with a digital document **172**. The digital document retriever **158** may be used to retrieve a digital document **172** from a digital document organizer **170** for presenting to a user. The digital document sharer **160** may be used to share one or more digital documents with a third party. The digital document organizer API may be used to allow a certifying authority to interface with the digital document organizer service (e.g., to allow the certifying authority to add, update, and/or delete digital documents to/from a digital document organizer **170**). The compliance badge generator **164** may be used to generate a compliance badge.

(40) While a particular organization/structure of components is shown in the diagram, it should be understood that such organization/structure is provided by way of example to illustrate a particular embodiment and that other embodiments may organize components differently to achieve the same/similar functionality. Example operations of various components of the programs **131** are described in additional detail herein below to illustrate an embodiment. For ease of description, the components are described herein as performing certain operations. Those skilled in the art will understand this to mean that the OSP computer system **195** is performing operations based on executing or activating those components.

(41) FIG. 2 is a diagram showing operations for generating a digital document organizer, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** submits a request to the OSP to create a digital document organizer **170** (e.g., through a GUI of the OSP). At operation **202**, the computer system **190** transmits a request to the digital document organizer generator **150** to generate the digital document organizer **170** for the user. Responsive to receiving this request, at operation **204**, the digital document organizer generator **150** generates a new digital document organizer **170** for the user. If the user's digital document organizer **170** is successfully generated, at operation **206**, the digital document organizer generator **150** transmits a confirmation to the computer system **190** indicating that the user's digital document organizer **170** has been generated. As will be described in additional detail herein, the digital document organizer **170** may be used to store, organize, and/or manage digital documents.

(42) FIG. 3 is a diagram showing operations for adding a digital document to a digital document organizer, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** submits a request to the OSP to add a digital document **172** to the user's digital document organizer **170** (e.g., through a GUI of the OSP). A digital document **172** may be a digital representation of a physical document or other collection of information/evidence that serves as an official record. For example, a digital document **172** may represent a certification, a license, an approval letter, a proof of insurance, a contract, a tax exemption certificate, or the like. In an embodiment, the digital document **172** represents a certification issued by a certifying authority **350**. A certifying authority **350** may be an entity that is authorized to issue certifications to organizations or individuals. For example, the digital document **172** may represent a tax exemption certificate granted by a tax authority. Sellers are often required

to charge sales tax on all transactions subject to tax except when a jurisdiction's rules allow for the sale to be made tax-exempt. A tax exemption certificate is a form that can be presented by an exempt organization or individual to the seller when making a tax-exempt purchase.

(43) A digital document **172** may take the form of a Portable Document Format (PDF) file, an image file, a text file, an extensible Markup Language (XML) file, a JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) file, and/or a Microsoft Word file. Of course, it should be understood that the digital document **172** may take other forms than listed above.

(44) At operation **302**, the computer system **190** transmits a request to add the digital document **172** to the user's digital document adder **152**. The request may include the digital document **172** to be added (e.g., as part of the payload of the request) or indicate that the digital document **172** is to be imported from a certifying authority **350** (or other official source of the digital document **172**). In the latter case, the request may include credentials provided by the user that will allow the digital document adder **152** to import the digital document **172** from the certifying authority **350** on behalf of the user. If the request indicates that the digital document **172** is to be imported from the certifying authority **350**, then at operation **304**, the digital document adder **152** imports the digital document **172** from the certifying authority **350** (e.g., using the user-provided credentials). This may be considered a “pull” mechanism where the OSP “pulls” the digital document **172** from the certifying authority **350**.

(45) Regardless of how the digital document adder **152** obtains the digital document **172**, at operation **306**, the digital document adder **152** adds the digital document **172** to the user's digital document organizer **170**. If the digital document **172** is successfully added to the user's digital document organizer **170**, at operation **308**, the digital document adder **152** transmits a confirmation to the computer system **190** indicating that the digital document **172** has been added to the user's digital document organizer **170**.

(46) FIG. 4A is a diagram showing operations for generating metadata associated with a digital document, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed at or around the time a digital document **172** is added to a digital document organizer **170**. At operation **402**, the digital document analyzer **154** analyzes the digital document **172** to generate metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172**. The metadata **174** may include information extracted from the digital document **172**, information related to the digital document **172** provided by the user of the OSP, information related to the digital document **172** provided by a certifying authority, or other information related to the digital document **172** that can otherwise be obtained by the digital document analyzer **154**. For example, if the digital document **172** represents a certification, the metadata **174** may include the expiration date of the certification. Other examples of metadata **174** include information regarding the certifying authority that issued the underlying document, the user's contact information, document type information (e.g., information to indicate that the underlying document is showing proof of insurance), and credential information (e.g., license number). In an embodiment, the digital document analyzer **154** uses optical character recognition (OCR) techniques to identify and extract relevant information from the digital document **172** and uses the information extracted from the digital document **172** to generate the metadata **174**. In an embodiment, the digital document analyzer **154** has pre-knowledge of the structure/organization of various types of documents. If the digital document analyzer **154** determines that a digital document **172** represents a particular type of document (e.g., a tax exemption certificate), then the digital document analyzer **154** may leverage the knowledge that it has about the structure/organization of the particular document type (e.g., knowledge of where certain fields of the document are located and how certain information is represented in the document (e.g., dates are represented in “MM/DD/YYYY” format)) to identify and extract the relevant information from the digital document **172**. At operation **404**, the digital document analyzer **154** stores the metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172** in the digital document organizer **170**. As will be described in additional detail herein, the metadata **174**

associated with the digital document **172** may be used to generate notifications associated with the digital document.

(47) FIG. **4B** is a diagram showing operations for generating a notification associated with a digital document, according to embodiments. At operation **406**, the notification generator **156** determines that a notification associated with the digital document **172** is to be generated based on the metadata **174**. For example, the notification generator **156** may determine that a notification associated with the digital document **172** is to be generated because an expiration date associated with the digital document **172** is approaching (e.g., the expiration date is less than threshold number of days away from the current date). At operation **408**, the notification generator **156** generates the notification associated with the digital document (e.g., indicating that the expiration date is approaching) and transmits the notification to the computer system **190**. The notification may be in the form of an email message to the user, a text message to the user, a telephone call to the user (e.g., a voice message), and/or a notification displayed in a GUI of the OSP. Of course, it should be understood that the notification may take other forms than listed above. In an embodiment, the notification includes a link that the user can access to automatically renew a certification. In an embodiment, the OSP is able to renew the certification on behalf of the user (e.g., by contacting the certifying authority on behalf of the user).

(48) FIG. **4C** is a diagram showing operations for generating and storing a hash value associated with a digital document, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed at or around the time a digital document **172** is added to a digital document organizer **170**. At operation **410**, the digital document analyzer **154** applies a hash algorithm to the digital document **172** to generate a hash value associated with the digital document **172**. Examples of hash algorithms that can be used include MD5 message-digest algorithm and Secure Hash Algorithm (e.g., SHA-1 and SHA-2), although it should be understood that other types of hash algorithms can be used. At operation **412**, the digital document analyzer **154** stores the hash value as part of the metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172**. As will be described in additional detail herein, the stored hash value may be used by the digital document retriever **158** to ensure that the digital document **172** has not been tampered with.

(49) FIG. **5** is a diagram showing operations for retrieving a digital document, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** submits a request to the OSP to view a digital document **172** in the user's digital document organizer **170** (e.g., through a GUI of the OSP). At operation **502**, the computer system **190** transmits a request to the digital document retriever **158** to view the digital document **172**. At operation **504**, the digital document retriever **158** retrieves the requested digital document **172** (e.g., from a database that stores the digital document **172**) and possibly metadata **174** associated with that digital document **172** (e.g., which may be metadata **174** generated by the digital document analyzer **154**). In an embodiment, at operation **506**, the digital document retriever **158** applies a hash algorithm (e.g., the same hash algorithm applied as part of operation **410** of FIG. **4C**) to the retrieved digital document **172** and ensures that the resulting hash value matches the previously stored hash value for the digital document **172** (e.g., the hash value stored as part of operation **412** of FIG. **4C**) to ensure that the digital document **172** has not been tampered with. If the hash value generated at the time of retrieving the digital document **172** is different from the hash value that was previously stored at or around the time that the digital document **172** was added to the digital document organizer **170** then this indicates that the digital document **172** may have been tampered with sometime after being added to the digital document organizer **170**. Thus, in an embodiment, the digital document retriever **158** does not transmit the digital document **172** (or its associated metadata **174**) to the computer system **190** if the hash values do not match. If the hash values match, at operation **508**, the digital document retriever **158** transmits the retrieved digital document **172** and possibly the metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172** to the computer system **190**. In an embodiment, the digital document **172** is transmitted (e.g., over a

network) in encrypted form (e.g., by using HTTPS). The computer system **190** may display the digital document **172** and possibly the metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172** to the user.

(50) FIG. **6A** is a diagram showing operations for sharing a digital document with a third party, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** submits a request to the OSP to share a digital document **172** (and possibly one or more aspects of metadata **174** associated with that digital document **172**) from the user's digital document organizer **170** with a third party **650** (e.g., through a GUI of the OSP). The third party may be an organization or an individual. At operation **602**, the computer system **190** transmits a request to the digital document sharer **160** to share the digital document **172** with the third party **650**. The third party **650** may or may not be a user of the OSP **198**. The request to share the digital document **172** may include the third party's email address, the third party's OSP user ID (e.g., if the third party is a user of the OSP), or other type of information identifying the third party **650**. At operation **604**, the digital document sharer **160** shares the digital document **172** with the third party **650**. In an embodiment, the digital document sharer **160** shares the digital document **172** with the third party **650** by generating a link (e.g., a uniform resource locator (URL)) that is usable by the third party to access the digital document **172** and transmits the link to the third party **650** such that the third party **650** can use the link to access the digital document **172**. As a result, at operation **606**, the third party **650** is able to access the digital document **172**.

(51) FIG. **6B** is a diagram showing operations for sharing a digital document with a third party with specified access rights until a specified access expiration date/time, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** submits a request to the OSP to share a digital document **172** (and possibly one or more aspects of metadata **174** associated with that digital document **172**) from the user's digital document organizer **170** with a third party **650** with specified access rights until a specified access expiration date/time (e.g., through a GUI of the OSP). At operation **608**, the computer system **190** transmits a request to the digital document sharer **160** to share the digital document **172** with the third party **650** with specified access rights (e.g., read only privileges or read and write privileges) until a specified access expiration date/time (e.g., for the next 24 hours). At operation **610**, the digital document sharer **160** shares the digital document **172** with the third party **650** via a uniform resource locator (URL) that includes an indication of the digital document that is being shared, an indication of the specified access rights, an indication of the specified access expiration date/time, and a digital signature of the URL (e.g., that is signed with a private key of the OSP). In an embodiment, the digital document sharer **160** generates the digital signature of the URL by performing a base64 encoding of the hash of the URL path and query string in alphabetical order. At operation **612**, the third party **650** uses the URL to access the shared digital document **172**. At operation **614**, the digital document sharer **160** verifies the digital signature included in the URL and verifies that access to the digital document **172** has not expired (e.g., by checking that the current time is before the specified access expiration date/time) before granting the specified access rights to the third party **650**. In an embodiment, the digital document sharer **160** verifies the digital signature included in the URL by performing the same operations that were used to generate the digital signature and ensuring that the resulting digital signature matches the digital signature included in the URL (which means that the parameter values in the query string have not been altered).

(52) As an example, the digital document sharer **160** may generate a URL **611**:

“https://wallet.example.com/user/exemption-certificate.pdf?expire=2022-08-31&rights=rw&sig=dZ0Jn65pGFgEiurqbU2Lmq9KZGBVICcL5znL5/krH/s=”

(53) This example URL **611** would provide the third party **650** with read and write access (“rights=rw”—“r” stands for read and “w” stands for write) to the “exemption-certificate.pdf”

digital document until Aug. 31, 2022 (“expire=2022-08-31”).

(54) The digital document sharer **160** may generate the digital signature using the following logic: `base64_encode(HASH(OspSSLCertificate, “exemption-certificate.pdf?expire=2022-08-31&rights=rw”))`, which returns the string

“dZ0Jn65pGFgEiurqbU2Lmq9KZGBVICcL5znL5/krH/s=”

(55) In the above logic, “base64_encode” is a base 64 encoding function, “HASH” is a hash function, and “OspSSLCertificate” is the OSP’s Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) certificate (which may include the OSP’s private key).

(56) FIG. 7 is a diagram showing operations for allowing a certifying authority to add, update, and/or delete digital documents, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** authorizes the certifying authority **750** to add, update, and/or delete digital documents **172** in the user’s digital document organizer **170** (e.g., through a GUI of the certifying authority **750**). At operation **702**, the computer system **190** authorizes the certifying authority **750** to add, update, and/or delete digital documents in the user’s digital document organizer **170**. As part of authorizing the certifying authority **750**, the computer system **190** may provide the location/ID of the user’s digital document organizer **170** to the certifying authority **750**. At operation **704**, the certifying authority **750** transmits an instruction to the digital document organizer API **162** to add, update, and/or delete a digital document **172** in the user’s digital document organizer **170**. The digital document organizer API **162** may be an API that the OSP exposes towards the certifying authority **750**. In an embodiment, the API is a REST API. If the instruction is an instruction to add a new digital document **172B** to the user’s digital document organizer **170**, then at operation **706A**, the digital document organizer API **162** adds the new digital document **172B** to the user’s digital document organizer **170** (metadata **174** associated with the digital document **172B** may also be generated (e.g., by the digital document analyzer **154**) and added to the user’s digital document organizer **170**). Otherwise, if the instruction is an instruction to update/replace an existing digital document **172A** in the user’s digital document organizer **170** or delete an existing digital document **172A** from the user’s digital document organizer **170**, then at operation **706B**, the digital document organizer API **162** updates/replaces or deletes the existing digital document **172A** (and possibly its associated metadata **174A**). This may be considered a “push” mechanism where the certifying authority **750** “pushes” a digital document **172** (or updates thereto) to the OSP.

(57) For example, a user of the OSP may take a Project Management Professional® exam offered by the Project Management Institute (PMI) and provide the location/ID of the user’s digital document organizer **170** to PMI. Upon passing the exam, PMI could use the digital document organizer API **162** to automatically add a digital document **172** representing the certification (indicating that the user passed the exam) to the user’s digital document organizer **170** and update/delete the digital document **172** if the user’s certification status changes.

(58) FIG. 8 is a diagram showing operations for generating a compliance badge, according to embodiments. The operations shown in the diagram may be performed when a user of the OSP operating the computer system **190** submits a request to the OSP to generate a compliance badge (e.g., through a GUI of the OSP). A compliance badge may be a certification issued by the OSP indicating that a user of the OSP (or the entity that the user represents) has the appropriate credentials and/or qualifications to operate in a specific industry and/or region. A compliance badge may be associated with a set of requirements in terms of the types of digital documents **172** (and possibly one or more aspects of metadata **174** associated with that digital document **172**) that a user must have in their digital document organizer **170** to be issued the compliance badge. For example, a compliance badge for a plumbing service may require that a user have digital documents representing a plumber journeyman license, a plumbing license for a particular state, and a proof of insurance in their digital document organizer **170**. Having a compliance badge issued by the OSP may help increase customer confidence in the business.

(59) At operation **802**, the computer system **190** transmits a request to the compliance badge generator **164** to generate a compliance badge. At operation **804**, the compliance badge generator **164** determines whether the digital document organizer **170** includes a set of digital documents (and possibly metadata) that fulfill a set of requirements associated with the compliance badge (and optionally validates the set of digital documents with certifying authorities and/or public records (e.g., to ensure that licenses are valid and have not expired)). If the compliance badge generator **164** determines that the digital document organizer **170** includes a set of digital documents that fulfill the set of requirements associated with the compliance badge, at operation **806A**, the compliance badge generator **164** generates the compliance badge and transmits the compliance badge to the computer system **190**. The user may provide the compliance badge to customers or potential customers to show that the user has the appropriate credentials and/or qualifications. The customers or potential customers may verify the compliance badge with the OSP and/or obtain more information about the compliance badge from the OSP. Additionally or alternatively to transmitting the compliance badge to the computer system **190**, at operation **806B**, the compliance badge generator **164** publishes the compliance badge to an external platform **850**. The external platform **850** may be, for example, an online business review/rating site or an online business directory such as Yelp®, Angie's List®, Houzz®, or Home Advisor®.

(60) FIG. **9A** and FIG. **9B** are flowcharts **900** describing methods, according to embodiments. While the flow diagrams in the figures show a particular order of operations performed by certain embodiments, it should be understood that such order is provided as an example and that other embodiments may perform the operations in a different order, combine certain operations, overlap certain operations, etc.

(61) At operation **905**, the OSP computer system generates a digital document organizer for a user of the OSP.

(62) At operation **910**, the OSP computer system adds at least a digital document to the digital document organizer. In an embodiment, the digital document represents, but is not limited to, any one of: a certification, a license, an approval letter, a proof of insurance, and a contract.

(63) In an embodiment, the OSP computer system receives, over a network, a request by the user to add the digital document to the digital document organizer, wherein the digital document is added to the digital document organizer in response to receiving the request to add the respective digital document to the digital document organizer. In an embodiment, the request to add the digital document to the digital document organizer includes the digital document. In an embodiment, the request to add the digital document to the digital document organizer indicates that the digital document is to be imported from a certifying authority. In such an embodiment, the OSP computer system may import the digital document from the certifying authority in response to receiving the request to add the digital document to the digital document organizer. In an embodiment, the OSP computer system receives, via an API exposed by the OSP towards the certifying authority, the digital document and an identifier of the digital document organizer, wherein the digital document is added to the digital document organizer in response to receiving the digital document and the identifier of the digital document organizer via the API. Thus, the digital document may be obtained directly from the user of the OSP (e.g., in the request payload), pulled/imported from the certifying authority, or pushed by the certifying authority to the OSP via an API exposed by the OSP towards the certifying authority. In an embodiment, the OSP computer system receives, via the API exposed by the OSP towards the certifying authority, an update to the digital document and updates the digital document in response to receiving the update via the API.

(64) At operation **915**, the OSP computer system generates metadata associated with the digital document based on analyzing the digital document. In an embodiment, the metadata includes an expiration date associated with the digital document. In an embodiment, the metadata includes a hash value associated with the digital document that is generated by applying a hash algorithm to the digital document when the digital document is added to the digital document organizer.

(65) At operation **920**, the OSP computer system stores the metadata associated with the digital document in a database.

(66) At operation **925**, the OSP computer system determines that a notification associated with the digital document is to be generated based on the metadata associated with the digital document. In an embodiment, the determination that the notification associated with the digital document is to be generated is based on a determination that an expiration date associated with the digital document (e.g., which may be included in the metadata associated with the digital document) is less than a threshold number of days away from the current date.

(67) At operation **930**, the OSP computer system generates the notification in response to the determination that the notification is to be generated.

(68) At operation **935**, the OSP computer system transmits, over a network, the notification such that the user can view the notification.

(69) Now referring to FIG. **9B**, at operation **940**, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to view the digital document.

(70) At operation **945**, the OSP computer system retrieves the digital document from a database in response to receiving the request to view the digital document.

(71) At operation **950**, the OSP computer system transmits, over the network, the digital document to a device operated by the user as a response to the request to view the digital document. In an embodiment, the OSP computer system applies a hash algorithm to the retrieved digital document and ensures that the resulting hash value matches a previously stored hash value for the digital document (e.g., to ensure that the digital document has not been tampered with) before transmitting the digital document to the device operated by the user.

(72) At operation **955**, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to share one or more digital documents in the digital document organizer with a third party (where the third party may be an organization or an individual).

(73) At operation **960**, the OSP computer system shares the one or more digital documents with the third party in response to receiving the request to share the one or more digital documents with the third party. In an embodiment, the OSP computer system shares the one or more digital documents by generating a link that is usable by the third party to access the one or more documents and transmitting, over the network, the link to the third party such that the third party can use the link to access the one or more digital documents. In an embodiment, the link is a URL that includes a query string, wherein the query string includes an indication of the one or more digital documents being shared, an indication of access rights being granted, an indication of an access expiration date/time, and a digital signature that was generated based on parts of the query string and signed by a private key (a private key of the OSP). In such an embodiment, when the OSP computer system receives a request to access the one or more documents via the URL, the OSP computer system may verify the digital signature included in the URL using the private key, verify that the access rights have not expired based on the access expiration date/time, and grant the access rights to the one or more documents in response to successfully verifying the digital signature and verifying that the access rights have not expired.

(74) At operation **965**, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to generate a compliance badge.

(75) At operation **970**, the OSP computer system generates the compliance badge in response to a determination that the digital document organizer includes a set of documents that fulfill a set of requirements associated with the compliance badge.

(76) At operation **970**, the OSP computer system transmits, over the network, the compliance badge such that the compliance badge can be published to an external platform.

(77) FIG. **10** shows details for example computer systems, according to embodiments. The computer system **1095** may be a server, while the computer system **1090** may be a personal device, such as a personal computer, a desktop computer, a personal computing device such as a laptop

computer, a tablet computer, a mobile phone, and so on. Either type may be used for the OSP computer system **195** and computer system **190** of FIG. **1**, and/or a computer system that is part of OPF **189**.

(78) The computer system **1095** and the computer system **1090** have similarities, which FIG. **10** exploits for purposes of economy in this document. It will be understood, however, that a component in the computer system **1095** may be implemented differently than the same component in the computer system **1090**. For instance, a memory in a server may be larger than a memory in a personal computer, and so on. Similarly, custom application programs **1074** that implement embodiments may be different, and so on.

(79) The computer system **1095** includes one or more processors **1094**. The processor(s) **1094** are one or more physical circuits that manipulate physical quantities representing data values. The manipulation can be according to control signals, which can be known as commands, op codes, machine code, etc. The manipulation can produce corresponding output signals that are applied to operate a machine. As such, one or more processors **1094** may, for example, include a Central Processing Unit (CPU), a Reduced Instruction Set Computing (RISC) processor, a Complex Instruction Set Computing (CISC) processor, a Graphics Processing Unit (GPU), a Digital Signal Processor (DSP), a Field-Programmable Gate Array (FPGA), an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC), any combination of these, and so on. A processor may further be a multi-core processor having two or more independent processors that execute instructions. Such independent processors are sometimes called “cores”.

(80) A hardware component such as a processor may also include programmable logic or circuitry that is temporarily configured by software to perform certain operations. For example, a hardware component may include software executed by a general-purpose processor or another type of programmable processor. Once configured by such software, hardware components become specific machines, or specific components of a machine, uniquely tailored to perform the configured functions and are no longer general-purpose processors. It will be appreciated that the decision to implement a hardware component mechanically, in dedicated and permanently configured circuitry, or in temporarily configured circuitry (e.g., configured by software) may be driven by cost and time considerations.

(81) As used herein, a “component” may refer to a device, physical entity or logic having boundaries defined by function or subroutine calls, branch points, Application Programming Interfaces (APIs), or other technologies that provide for the partitioning or modularization of particular processing or control functions. Components may be combined via their interfaces with other components to carry out a machine process. A component may be a packaged functional hardware unit designed for use with other components and a part of a program that usually performs a particular function of related functions. Components may constitute either software components (e.g., code embodied on a machine-readable medium) or hardware components. The hardware components depicted in the computer system **1095**, or the computer system **1090**, are not intended to be exhaustive. Rather, they are representative, for highlighting essential components that can be used with embodiments.

(82) The computer system **1095** also includes a system bus **1012** that is coupled to the processor(s) **1094**. The system bus **1012** can be used by the processor(s) **1094** to control and/or communicate with other components of the computer system **1095**.

(83) The computer system **1095** additionally includes a network interface **1019** that is coupled to system bus **1012**. Network interface **1019** can be used to access a communications network, such as the network **188**. Network interface **1019** can be implemented by a hardware network interface, such as a Network Interface Card (NIC), wireless communication components, cellular communication components, Near Field Communication (NFC) components, Bluetooth® components such as Bluetooth® Low Energy, Wi-Fi® components, etc. Of course, such a hardware network interface may have its own software, and so on.

(84) The computer system **1095** also includes various memory components. These memory components include memory components shown separately in the computer system **1095**, plus cache memory within the processor(s) **1094**. Accordingly, these memory components are examples of non-transitory machine-readable media. The memory components shown separately in the computer system **1095** are variously coupled, directly or indirectly, with the processor(s) **1094**. The coupling in this example is via the system bus **1012**.

(85) Instructions for performing any of the methods or functions described in this document may be stored, completely or partially, within the memory components of the computer system **1095**, etc. Therefore, one or more of these non-transitory computer-readable media can be configured to store instructions which, when executed by one or more processors **1094** of a host computer system such as the computer system **1095** or the computer system **1090**, can cause the host computer system to perform operations according to embodiments. The instructions may be implemented by computer program code for carrying out operations for aspects of this document. The computer program code may be written in any combination of one or more programming languages, including an object-oriented programming language such as Java, Smalltalk or the like, and/or conventional procedural programming languages, such as the “C” programming language or similar programming languages such as C++, C Sharp, etc.

(86) The memory components of the computer system **1095** include a non-volatile hard drive **1033**. The computer system **1095** further includes a hard drive interface **1032** that is coupled to the hard drive **1033** and to the system bus **1012**.

(87) The memory components of the computer system **1095** include a system memory **1038**. The system memory **1038** includes volatile memory including, but not limited to, cache memory, registers and buffers. In embodiments, data from the hard drive **1033** populates registers of the volatile memory of the system memory **1038**.

(88) In some embodiments, the system memory **1038** has a software architecture that uses a stack of layers, with each layer providing a particular functionality. In this example the layers include, starting from the bottom, an Operating System (OS) **1050**, libraries **1060**, frameworks/middleware **1068** and application programs **1070**, which are also known as applications **1070**. Other software architectures may include less, more or different layers. For example, a presentation layer may also be included. For another example, some mobile or special purpose operating systems may not provide a frameworks/middleware **1068**.

(89) The OS **1050** may manage hardware resources and provide common services. The libraries **1060** provide a common infrastructure that is used by the applications **1070** and/or other components and/or layers. The libraries **1060** provide functionality that allows other software components to perform tasks more easily than if they interfaced directly with the specific underlying functionality of the OS **1050**. The libraries **1060** may include system libraries **1061**, such as a C standard library. The system libraries **1061** may provide functions such as memory allocation functions, string manipulation functions, mathematical functions, and the like.

(90) In addition, the libraries **1060** may include API libraries **1062** and other libraries **1063**. The API libraries **1062** may include media libraries, such as libraries to support presentation and manipulation of various media formats such as MPREG4, H.264, MP3, AAC, AMR, JPG, and PNG. The API libraries **1062** may also include graphics libraries, for instance an OpenGL framework that may be used to render 2D and 3D in a graphic content on the screen **1091**. The API libraries **1062** may further include database libraries, for instance SQLite, which may support various relational database functions. The API libraries **1062** may additionally include web libraries, for instance WebKit, which may support web browsing functionality, and also libraries for applications **1070**.

(91) The frameworks/middleware **1068** may provide a higher-level common infrastructure that may be used by the applications **1070** and/or other software components/modules. For example, the frameworks/middleware **1068** may provide various Graphic User Interface (GUI) functions, high-

level resource management, high-level location services, and so forth. The frameworks/middleware **1068** may provide a broad spectrum of other APIs that may be used by the applications **1070** and/or other software components/modules, some of which may be specific to the OS **1050** or to a platform.

(92) The application programs **1070** are also known more simply as applications and apps. One such app is a browser **1071**, which is a software that can permit the user **192** to access other devices in the internet, for example while using a Graphic User Interface (GUI). The browser **1071** includes program modules and instructions that enable the computer system **1095** to exchange network messages with a network, for example using Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP) messaging.

(93) The application programs **1070** may include one or more custom applications **1074**, made according to embodiments. These can be made so as to cause their host computer to perform operations according to embodiments. Of course, when implemented by software, operations according to embodiments may be implemented much faster than may be implemented by a human mind; for example, tens or hundreds of such operations may be performed per second according to embodiments, which is much faster than a human mind can do.

(94) Other such applications **1070** may include a contacts application, a QR code reader application, a book reader application, a location application, a media application, a messaging application, and so on. Applications **1070** may be developed using the ANDROID™ or IOS™ Software Development Kit (SDK) by an entity other than the vendor of the particular platform, and may be mobile software running on a mobile operating system such as IOS™, ANDROID™, WINDOWS®-related, or other mobile operating systems. The applications **1070** may use built-in functions of the OS **1050**, of the libraries **1060**, and of the frameworks/middleware **1068** to create user interfaces for the user **192** to interact with.

(95) The computer system **1095** moreover includes a bus bridge **1020** coupled to the system bus **1012**. The computer system **1095** furthermore includes an input/output (I/O) bus **1021** coupled to the bus bridge **1020**. The computer system **1095** also includes an I/O interface **1022** coupled to the I/O bus **1021**.

(96) For being accessed, the computer system **1095** also includes one or more Universal Serial Bus (USB) ports **1029**. These can be coupled to the I/O interface **1022**. The computer system **1095** further includes a media tray **1026**, which may include storage devices such as CD-ROM drives, multi-media interfaces, and so on.

(97) The computer system **1090** may include many components similar to those of the computer system **1095**, as seen in FIG. 10. In addition, a number of the application programs may be more suitable for the computer system **1090** than for the computer system **1095**.

(98) The computer system **1090** further includes peripheral input/output (I/O) devices for being accessed by a user more routinely. As such, the computer system **1090** includes a screen **1091** and a video adapter **1028** to drive and/or support the screen **1091**. The video adapter **1028** is coupled to the system bus **1012**.

(99) The computer system **1090** also includes a keyboard **1023**, a mouse **1024**, and a printer **1025**. In this example, the keyboard **1023**, the mouse **1024**, and the printer **1025** are directly coupled to the I/O interface **1022**. Sometimes this coupling is via the USB ports **1029**.

(100) In this context, “machine-readable medium” refers to a component, device or other tangible media able to store instructions and data temporarily or permanently and may include, but is not be limited to, a portable computer diskette, a thumb drive, a hard disk, random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), buffer memory, flash memory, optical media, magnetic media, cache memory, an Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory (EPROM), an optical fiber, a portable compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. The machine that would read such a medium includes one or more processors **1094**.

(101) The term “machine-readable medium” should be taken to include a single medium or

multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, or associated caches and servers) able to store instructions that a machine such as a processor can store, erase, or read. The term “machine-readable medium” shall also be taken to include any medium, or combination of multiple media, that is capable of storing instructions (e.g., code) for execution by a machine, such that the instructions, when executed by one or more processors of the machine, cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methods described herein. Accordingly, instructions transform a general, non-programmed machine into a particular machine programmed to carry out the described and illustrated functions in the manner described.

(102) A computer readable signal traveling from, to, and via these components may include a propagated data signal with computer readable program code embodied therein, for example, in baseband or as part of a carrier wave. Such a propagated signal may take any of a variety of forms, including, but not limited to, electro-magnetic, optical, or any suitable combination thereof. A computer readable signal medium may be any computer readable medium that is not a computer readable storage medium and that can communicate, propagate, or transport a program for use by or in connection with an instruction execution system, apparatus, or device.

(103) FIG. **11** is diagram for an operational example and use case where the digital document organizer is a digital wallet for storing, organizing, and managing digital documents representing business documents.

(104) It will be recognized that aspects of FIG. **11** have similarities with aspects of FIG. **1**. Portions of such aspects may be implemented as described for analogous aspects of FIG. **1**.

(105) An OSP computer system **1195** is shown, which is used to help customers of the OSP **1198**, such as a user **1192**, to store, organize, and/or manage digital documents representing their business documents in a digital wallet. Further in this example, the OSP computer system **1195** is part of an OSP **1198** that is implemented as a Software as a Service (SaaS) provider, for being accessed online by clients, such as the user **1192**. Alternately, the functionality of the OSP computer system **1195** may be provided locally to a user.

(106) The user **1192** may be standalone. The user **1192** may use a computer system **1190** that has a screen **1191**. In embodiments, the user **1192** and the computer system **1190** are considered part of the entity **1193**. The entity **1193** can be a business, such as a seller of items, a reseller, a buyer, and so on. In such instances, the user **1192** can be an owner, an employee, a contractor, or otherwise an agent of the entity **1193**.

(107) In a number of instances, the user **1192** and/or the entity **1193** use software applications to manage their business activities, such as sales, resource management, production, inventory management, delivery, billing, and so on. The user **1192** and/or the entity **1193** may further use accounting applications to manage purchase orders, sales invoices, refunds, payroll, accounts payable, accounts receivable, and so on. Such software applications, and more, may be used locally by the user **1192**, or from an Online Processing Facility (OPF) **1189** that has been engaged for this purpose by the user **1192** and/or the entity **1193**. In such use cases, the OPF **1189** can be a Mobile Payments system, a Point Of Sale (POS) system, an Accounting application, an Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) provider, an e-commerce provider, an electronic marketplace, a Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system, and so on.

(108) Conventional digital wallets have limited capabilities. With conventional digital wallets, the wallet items (e.g., credit cards) are managed on the end user device. If the end user gets a new device, this requires setting up a new digital wallet on the new device and importing existing wallet contents from the previous device to the new device. Also, with conventional digital wallets, the items in the digital wallet may have expiration dates but the digital wallet does not notify the user when expiration dates are approaching (e.g., this may result in the user forgetting to renew/update their credit card and trying to use a credit card that is no longer valid).

(109) The OSP computer system **1195** may be configured to provide a digital wallet service that addresses one or more of the above-mentioned deficiencies of conventional digital wallets. The

digital wallet service may allow users to store, organize, and manage digital documents representing business documents in a centralized manner. Embodiments of the digital wallet service may store digital wallets in a central location accessible over a network (e.g., the internet), and thus allows users to access their digital wallets from anywhere and with any suitable device. Unlike conventional digital wallets where the wallet items are fully digital from the start, embodiments of the digital wallet service described herein allow users to convert paper/physical documents to a digital document and store the digital document in the user's digital wallet. Also, embodiments of the digital wallet service described herein may notify users when their digital documents are about to expire.

(110) The OSP computer system **1195** may have one or more processors and memory, for example as was described for the OSP computer system **195** of FIG. **1**. The OSP computer system **1195** thus implements a wallet engine **1183** to provide a digital wallet service for users of the OSP. The wallet engine **1183** can be as described for the service engine **183**.

(111) In the implementation of FIG. **11**, the OSP **1198** has a database **1194** for storing data **138** regarding digital wallets **170** for users. For example, the database **1194** may store digital wallet **170A**, which includes a digital document **172A** representing a tax exemption certificate and its associated metadata **174A** (e.g., the document type, the expiration date, etc.), a digital document **172B** representing a business license and its associated metadata **174B** (e.g., the document type, the expiration date, etc.), and a digital document **172N** representing a proof of insurance and its associated metadata **174N** (e.g., the document type, the expiration date, etc.). The database **1194** may store additional digital wallets (e.g., for other users of the OSP **1198**). The digital documents **172** in a digital wallet **170** may have been provided to the OSP by users of the OSP and/or by a set of certifying authorities **1180** such as certifying authority **1181** and **1182**. It should be noted that the diagram shows a logical depiction of the data **138** for illustration purposes and is not meant to show how the data **138** is actually stored/structured/organized in the database **1194**. Those skilled in the art will understand that there are various possible ways that the data **138** may be stored/structured/organized in the database **1194**.

(112) Under the control of the user **1192**, the computer system **1190** may transmit a request **1184** that includes a payload **1134** to the computer system **195**. The request **1184** may be a request to create a new digital wallet **170** for the user **1192**, a request to add a digital document to the user's digital wallet **170**, a request to view a digital document included in the user's digital wallet **170**, a request to share a set of digital documents included in the user's digital wallet with a third party, or a request to generate a compliance badge. The payload **1134** of the request **1184** may vary depending on the type of request. Data may be provided to the computer system **1195** via one payload **1134** or multiple payloads. Responsive to receiving the request **1184**, the computer system **195** may perform operations to fulfill the request (e.g., as described herein above) and transmit a corresponding response **1187** that includes a payload **1137** to the computer system **1190**. The payload **1137** of the response **1187** may vary depending on the type of response being provided. Data may be provided to the computer system **1190** via one payload **1137** or multiple payloads.

(113) FIG. **12A**, FIG. **12B**, and FIG. **12C** are flowcharts **1200** describing methods for a digital wallet use case, according to embodiments.

(114) At operation **1205**, the OSP computer system generates a digital wallet for a user of the OSP.

(115) At operation **1210**, the OSP computer system adds at least a digital document representing an exemption certificate (also referred to as a “digital exemption certificate” herein) to the digital wallet. The digital exemption certificate may have been obtained directly from the user of the OSP, imported from a tax authority, or pushed by a tax authority to the OSP via an API exposed by the OSP towards the tax authority.

(116) At operation **1215**, the OSP computer system generates an expiration date associated with the digital exemption certificate based on analyzing the digital exemption certificate (e.g., based on extracting the expiration date from the digital exemption certificate). In an embodiment, the OSP

also applies a hash algorithm to the digital exemption certificate to generate a hash value associated with the digital exemption certificate.

(117) At operation **1220**, the OSP computer system stores the expiration date associated with the exemption certificate (and possibly the hash value) in a database.

(118) At operation **1225**, the OSP computer system determines that a notification associated with the digital exemption certificate is to be generated based on the expiration date associated with the digital exemption certificate (e.g., based on the expiration date being less than a threshold number of days away).

(119) At operation **1230**, the OSP computer system generates the notification (e.g., indicating that the exemption certificate is about to expire) in response to the determination that the notification is to be generated.

(120) At operation **1235**, the OSP computer system transmits, over a network, the notification such that the user can view the notification.

(121) Now referring to FIG. **12B**, at operation **1240**, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to view the digital exemption certificate.

(122) At operation **1245**, the OSP computer system retrieves the digital exemption certificate from a database in response to receiving the request to view the digital exemption certificate. In an embodiment, the OSP computer system applies a hash algorithm to the digital exemption certificate and verifies that the resulting hash value matches a previously stored hash value for the digital exemption certificate (e.g., to ensure that the digital exemption certificate has not been tampered with).

(123) At operation **1250**, the OSP computer system transmits, over the network, the digital exemption certificate to a device operated by the user as a response to the request to view the digital exemption certificate (e.g., if the hash values match).

(124) At operation **1255**, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to share the digital exemption certificate with a third party (where the third party may be an organization or an individual).

(125) At operation **1260**, the OSP computer system shares the digital exemption certificate with the third party in response to receiving the request to share the digital exemption certificate with the third party. For example, the OSP computer system may share the digital document by generating a link that is usable by the third party to access the digital exemption certificate and providing the link to the third party. In an embodiment, the link is a URL that indicates the digital exemption certificate being shared, the access rights being granted, the access expiration date/time, and a digital signature generated based on parts of the URL and signed by a private key.

(126) Now referring to FIG. **12C**, at operation **1265**, the OSP computer system receives, over the network, a request by the user to generate a compliance badge for plumbing services.

(127) At operation **1270**, the OSP computer system generates the compliance badge in response to a determination that the digital wallet includes a digital document representing a plumber journeyman license, a digital document representing a plumbing license for the relevant state/jurisdiction, and a digital document representing a proof of insurance (e.g., this is the set of documents that fulfill the requirements associated with the compliance badge for plumbing services).

(128) At operation **1275**, the OSP computer system transmits, over the network, the compliance badge for plumbing services such that the compliance badge can be published to an external platform.

(129) FIG. **13A** is a diagram showing a GUI for uploading a digital document to a digital wallet service, according to embodiments. The OSP computer system **1195** may cause the GUI to be projected onto the screen **1191**. The GUI may be particularly suitable for displaying on a screen of a mobile device such as a smartphone or tablet.

(130) The GUI shows a banner with the service provider's name ("OSP" in this example) and the

name of the digital wallet service being provided (“Credential Wallet” in this example). The GUI also shows a button to select a document from a photo gallery (“Select Document from Gallery”) and a button to take a picture of the document using a camera (“Use Camera”). The GUI shows a “Document Name” input field, a “Document Type” input field, a “Renewal Date” input field, a “Location” input field, a “Notes” input field, and a “Tags” input field. The GUI further shows a button to save the inputs (“Save”). The GUI further shows icons at the bottom portion for accessing various functionalities related to the digital wallet service such as a “Credentials” icon, a “Calendar” icon, an “Upload” icon, a “Share” icon, and an “Account” icon.

(131) FIG. 13B is a diagram showing a GUI for uploading a digital document to a digital wallet service after the user has provided a digital document to be uploaded, according to embodiments.

(132) In this example, it is assumed that the user provided a digital proof of insurance document through the GUI (by selecting an image of the proof of insurance document from a photo gallery or taking a picture of the proof of insurance document using a camera). The GUI shows a preview of the digital proof of insurance. In an embodiment, the OSP analyzes the provided digital document to extract various metadata associated with the digital proof of insurance document and automatically populates the various input fields of the GUI with the extracted metadata. For example, the OSP may auto-populate one or more of the

(133) “Document Name” input field, the “Document Type” input field, the “Renewal Date” input field, the “Location” input field, a “Notes” input field, and the “Tags” input field, as shown in the diagram. One or more of the fields may be editable by the user through the GUI. In an embodiment, the OSP auto-populates a subset of the input fields and the user is expected to enter values into the other input fields. When the user is satisfied with the preview and the values of the input fields, the user may activate the “Save” button (e.g., by clicking/tapping on the button) to upload the digital proof of insurance document to the OSP and add the digital proof of insurance document (along with the associated metadata) to the user's digital wallet.

(134) FIG. 14 is a diagram showing a GUI for sharing a digital document, according to embodiments. The GUI may be particularly suitable for displaying on a screen of a desktop computer.

(135) The GUI shows a user interface element for selecting one or more digital credentials to share with a third party. The GUI further shows an input field for entering the email address of the third party (“john.doe@osp.com” in this example) and an input field for entering a message for the third party (“Hi John. Here are my credentials. Looking forward to doing business with you” in this example). When the user has finished selecting the digital credentials to be shared and populating the relevant input fields, the user may activate the “Send” button to share the digital credentials with the third party. The GUI also shows a “Copy Link” button that the user can activate to copy a link that the third party can use to access the shared digital credentials to the user's clipboard.

(136) FIG. 15 is a diagram showing another GUI for sharing a digital document, according to embodiments. The GUI may be particularly suitable for displaying on a screen of a mobile device such as a smartphone or tablet.

(137) Similar to the GUI shown in FIG. 14, the GUI shows a user interface element for selecting one or more digital credentials to share with a third party, an input field for entering the email address of the third party, an input field for entering a message for the third party, a “Send” button, and a “Copy Link” button. The user can interact with this GUI in a similar manner as described above to share one or more digital credentials with a third party.

(138) FIG. 16A is a diagram showing an email informing a third party that a user of the OSP has shared digital credentials with the third party, according to embodiments. The email may have been sent to a third party as a result of the user of the OSP sharing a set of digital credentials with the third party, for example, using the GUI shown in FIG. 14 or FIG. 15.

(139) The email is addressed to the third party (“John” in this example) and indicates that the user of the OSP (“Plumber Joe” in this example) has shared digital credentials with the third party. The

email indicates when access to the shared digital credentials will expire (“Jul. 30, 2021” in this example) and includes a customized message and a button/link for viewing the digital credentials shared by the user of the OSP with the third party (“View Credentials”).

(140) FIG. 16B is a diagram showing a GUI for viewing digital documents shared by a user of the OSP, according to embodiments. The GUI may be shown on the display of the device operated by the third party as a result of the third party clicking on the “View Credentials” button/link shown in FIG. 16A. The GUI may be shown within an OSP application (or “app”) running on the user's device. The GUI shows thumbnails of the set of digital credentials being shared with the third party (a New York business license, a New York food prep license, and a proof of insurance in this example). The GUI further shows when access to the digital credentials expires (“Jul. 30, 2021” in this example). The GUI further shows a button to save the digital credentials to the third party's own digital wallet (e.g., if the third party is also a user of the OSP and has a digital wallet).

(141) FIG. 17A is a diagram showing a GUI for notifying a user that a credential is about to expire, according to embodiments. The GUI shows a set of digital credentials that are currently in the user's digital wallet. The GUI further shows that one of the digital credentials (the New York Plumbers license in this example) will be expiring (on “Jun. 24, 2021” in this example).

(142) FIG. 17B is a diagram showing an email for notifying a user of the OSP that a credential is about to expire, according to embodiments. The email may be sent as a result of the OSP determining that one of the user's credentials is about to expire.

(143) The email indicates that one of the user's credentials (the New York Plumbers license in this example) is due to expire on Jun. 24, 2021 and also includes a button/link to renew the license through the OSP (“Let us renew it for you”) and a button/link to view the digital credential (“View Document”).

(144) FIG. 18 is a diagram showing a GUI for publishing a compliance badge, according to embodiments. The GUI shows a list of platforms to which a compliance badge can be published. The GUI may allow the user of the OSP to select one or more of the platforms to which to publish a compliance badge. The GUI further shows a button to select all of the platforms (“Select All”) and a button to deselect all of the platforms (“Deselect All”).

(145) If the user publishes a compliance badge to a platform, the platform may indicate that the user's business has the necessary certifications/qualifications for performing the services associated with the compliance badge. For example, in the example shown in the diagram, the platform indicates that the “Lane Plumbing” business has a compliance badge for providing a plumbing service, a water heater installation/repair service, and a hydro-jetting service. The platform may provide additional details about a particular compliance badge if requested by a user of the platform. For example, in the example shown in the diagram, the platform shows additional details about the compliance badge for plumbing services such as the license number, the issuing/certifying authority, the license type, and when the license was last verified.

(146) A person skilled in the art will be able to practice the present invention in view of this description, which is to be taken as a whole. Details have been included to provide a thorough understanding. In other instances, well-known aspects have not been described, in order to not obscure unnecessarily this description.

(147) Some technologies or techniques described in this document may be known. Even then, however, it does not necessarily follow that it is known to apply such technologies or techniques as described in this document, or for the purposes described in this document.

(148) This description includes one or more examples, but this fact does not limit how the invention may be practiced. Indeed, examples, instances, versions or embodiments of the invention may be practiced according to what is described, or yet differently, and also in conjunction with other present or future technologies. Other such embodiments include combinations and sub-combinations of features described herein, including for example, embodiments that are equivalent to the following: providing or applying a feature in a different order than in a described

embodiment; extracting an individual feature from one embodiment and inserting such feature into another embodiment; removing one or more features from an embodiment; or both removing a feature from an embodiment and adding a feature extracted from another embodiment, while providing the features incorporated in such combinations and sub-combinations.

(149) A number of embodiments are possible, each including various combinations of elements. When one or more of the appended drawings—which are part of this specification—are taken together, they may present some embodiments with their elements in a manner so compact that these embodiments can be surveyed quickly. This is true even if these elements are described individually extensively in this text, and these elements are only optional in other embodiments.

(150) In general, the present disclosure reflects preferred embodiments of the invention. The attentive reader will note, however, that some aspects of the disclosed embodiments extend beyond the scope of the claims. To the respect that the disclosed embodiments indeed extend beyond the scope of the claims, the disclosed embodiments are to be considered supplementary background information and do not constitute definitions of the claimed invention.

(151) In this document, the phrases “constructed to”, “adapted to” and/or “configured to” denote one or more actual states of construction, adaptation and/or configuration that is fundamentally tied to physical characteristics of the element or feature preceding these phrases and, as such, reach well beyond merely describing an intended use. Any such elements or features can be implemented in a number of ways, as will be apparent to a person skilled in the art after reviewing the present disclosure, beyond any examples shown in this document.

(152) Parent patent applications: Any and all parent, grandparent, great-grandparent, etc. patent applications, whether mentioned in this document or in an Application Data Sheet (“ADS”) of this patent application, are hereby incorporated by reference herein as originally disclosed, including any priority claims made in those applications and any material incorporated by reference, to the extent such subject matter is not inconsistent herewith.

(153) Reference numerals: In this description a single reference numeral may be used consistently to denote a single item, aspect, component, or process. Moreover, a further effort may have been made in the preparation of this description to use similar though not identical reference numerals to denote other versions or embodiments of an item, aspect, component or process that are identical or at least similar or related. Where made, such a further effort was not required, but was nevertheless made gratuitously so as to accelerate comprehension by the reader. Even where made in this document, such a further effort might not have been made completely consistently for all of the versions or embodiments that are made possible by this description. Accordingly, the description controls in defining an item, aspect, component or process, rather than its reference numeral. Any similarity in reference numerals may be used to infer a similarity in the text, but not to confuse aspects where the text or other context indicates otherwise.

(154) The claims of this document define certain combinations and sub-combinations of elements, features and acts or operations, which are regarded as novel and non-obvious. The claims also include elements, features and acts or operations that are equivalent to what is explicitly mentioned. Additional claims for other such combinations and sub-combinations may be presented in this or a related document. These claims are intended to encompass within their scope all changes and modifications that are within the true spirit and scope of the subject matter described herein. The terms used herein, including in the claims, are generally intended as “open” terms. For example, the term “including” should be interpreted as “including but not limited to,” the term “having” should be interpreted as “having at least,” etc. If a specific number is ascribed to a claim recitation, this number is a minimum but not a maximum unless stated otherwise. For example, where a claim recites “a” component or “an” item, it means that the claim can have one or more of this component or this item.

(155) In construing the claims of this document, 35 U.S.C. § 112 (f) is invoked by the inventor(s) only when the words “means for” or “steps for” are expressly used in the claims. Accordingly, if

these words are not used in a claim, then that claim is not intended to be construed by the inventor(s) in accordance with 35 U.S.C. § 112 (f).

(156) While the invention has been described in terms of several embodiments, those skilled in the art will recognize that the invention is not limited to the embodiments described, can be practiced with modification and alteration within the spirit and scope of the appended claims. The description is thus to be regarded as illustrative instead of limiting.

Claims

1. A method performed by a computer system, the method comprising: generating a digital document organizer for a user of an online software platform; adding at least a digital document to the digital document organizer, wherein the digital document represents a certification issued by a certifying authority; generating metadata associated with the digital document based on analyzing the digital document; storing the metadata associated with the digital document; receiving, over a network, a request by the user to view the digital document; retrieving the digital document from a database in response to receiving the request to view the digital document; transmitting, over the network, the digital document and the metadata associated with the digital document to a device operated by the user as a response to the request to view the document; receiving, over the network, a request by the user to share one or more documents in the digital document organizer with a third party; responsive to receiving the request to share the one or more documents, generating a uniform resource locator (URL) that is usable by the third party to access the one or more documents, wherein the URL includes a query string and a digital signature that was generated based on at least a portion of the query string and signed by a private key of the online software platform; transmitting, over the network, the URL to the third party such that the third party can use the URL to access the one or more digital documents; receiving a request to access the one or more documents via the URL; and verifying the digital signature included in the URL using the private key of the online software platform before granting access to the one or more documents.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the metadata associated with the digital document includes a first hash value associated with the digital document that is generated by applying a hash algorithm to the digital document when the digital document is added to the digital document organizer, wherein the method further comprises: applying the hash algorithm to the digital document after the digital document is retrieved from the database to generate a second hash value; and ensuring that the second hash value matches the first hash value before transmitting the digital document to the device operated by the user.
3. The method of claim 1, further comprising: determining that a notification associated with the digital document is to be generated based on the metadata associated with the digital document; generating the notification associated with the digital document in response to the determination that the notification associated with the digital document is to be generated; and transmitting, over the network, the notification associated with the digital document such that the user can view the notification.
4. The method of claim 3, wherein the metadata associated with the digital document includes an expiration date associated with the digital document, wherein the determination that the notification associated with the digital document is to be generated is based on a determination that the expiration date is less than a threshold number of days away from a current date.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the query string further includes an indication of the one or more digital documents being shared, an indication of access rights being granted, and an indication of an access expiration date, wherein the method further comprises: verifying that the access rights have not expired based on the access expiration date; and granting the access rights to the one or more documents in response to successfully verifying the digital signature and verifying that the access rights have not expired.

6. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, over the network, a request by the user to add the digital document to the digital document organizer, wherein the digital document is added to the digital document organizer in response to receiving the request to add the respective digital document to the digital document organizer.
 7. The method of claim 6, wherein the request to add the digital document to the digital document organizer includes the digital document.
 8. The method of claim 6, wherein the request to add the digital document to the digital document organizer indicates that the digital document is to be imported from the certifying authority, wherein the method further comprises: importing the digital document from the certifying authority in response to receiving the request to add the digital document to the digital document organizer.
 9. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, via an application programming interface (API) exposed by the online software platform towards the certifying authority, the digital document and an identifier of the digital document organizer, wherein the digital document is added to the digital document organizer in response to receiving the digital document and the identifier of the digital document organizer via the API.
 10. The method of claim 9, further comprising: receiving, via the API exposed by the online software platform towards the certifying authority, an update to the digital document; and updating the digital document in response to receiving the update via the API.
 11. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, over the network, a request by the user to generate a compliance badge; generating the compliance badge in response to a determination that the digital document organizer includes a set of documents that fulfill a set of requirements associated with the compliance badge; and transmitting, over the network, the compliance badge such that the compliance badge can be published to an external platform.
 12. The method of claim 1, further comprising: adding at least another digital document to the digital document organizer, wherein the another digital document represents any one of: a license, an approval letter, a proof of insurance, and a contract.
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